

Week 13: Morality

BIG IDEA

Morality seems straightforward, but students are taught that moral claims, even murder being wrong, are matters of opinion, so when you present Scripture as fact they may hear only your opinion. Like little Johnny measuring himself in Johnnys, we need a standard beyond ourselves, and having morals at all points us to God.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- When leaders present Christian truth as black-and-white fact, students taught otherwise may be thinking, 'that's your opinion, and I'm not sure I agree.'
- Meet with your small group leaders and gather student feedback on right versus wrong; some answers may not thrill you, but it's a starting point.
- The speaker's students copied homework in the hallways and, when asked if it was wrong, simply answered no, 'because we just don't' think it is.
- Education increasingly frames right and wrong as opinion, a slippery slope from copying homework to equality, drinking age, unjust killing, and same-sex marriage.
- Little Johnny measuring himself as 'one Johnny tall' shows we can't measure ourselves by ourselves; morality likewise needs an external standard, which points us to God.
- Respond with grace and love: listen thoroughly, ask where their ideas come from, and don't be afraid to challenge their thinking without shooting them down.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. When you present what Scripture says as fact, how many of your students are hearing it as just your opinion?
2. Is 'all people are created equal' a fact or an opinion? What about murder being wrong?
3. Where are your students getting their ideas about right and wrong: classes, teachers, home, online, TV?
4. Why does needing a moral standard beyond ourselves point us to God?

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